

L^AT_EX for Primary Source Handouts

Corey Stephan, Ph.D.

🏠 coreystephan.com

May 14, 2026

The world's best established software system for typesetting and document formatting, L^AT_EX has been popular throughout the mathematical and physical sciences for decades. The utility of L^AT_EX for scholars in humanities disciplines, however, tends to be overlooked.

L^AT_EX can be used for typesetting in (almost) all instances in which a scholar of humanities needs to present our materials elegantly.

I have prepared these slides in L^AT_EX – more quickly and with less frustration than would have been possible in graphical presentation program (e.g. LibreOffice Present).

This Tutorial

In this tutorial, I will introduce attendees to the use of LaTeX for a common task in medievalist scholarship, namely, typesetting texts with unusual line length and other organizational needs, such as primary texts with our original translations.

The specific example will be preparing a handout for a historical conference or class presentation with perfectly organized excerpts of a Byzantine Greek text and an original English translation in parallel.

This Tutorial

I will walk attendees in sequence through setup, formatting, and, finally, viewing a document of this kind – talking about different approaches that one might take depending on needs, such as placing right-to-left (notably, Semitic) and left-to-right languages side-by-side.

I aim to inspire attendees to think about L^AT_EX as a highly flexible tool with a wider range of professional applications than it often is understood as having.